



Before dinosaurs

By 310 MYA there were reptiles, amphibians, invertebrates, and fish. Trilobites, sea creatures similar to woodlice, died out before the dinosaurs even appeared.



» 235 million years ago

First dinosaurs

The earliest dinosaurs appeared around 235 MYA. Dinosaurs like Eoraptor lived alongside other huge reptiles.

» 130 MYA

Iguanodon

This dinosaur existed for about five million years in the Cretaceous period.



» 140 MYA

First ceratopsians

These horned dinosaurs made their entrance in the Early Cretaceous.



» 155 MYA

First birds

Archaeopteryx was one of the first birds.



» 125 MYA

First flowering plants

The first flowers were small compared to ones today. By 100 MYA many recognizable flowers were blooming, such as magnolias.



» 112 MYA

Spinosaurus

Spinosaurus walked the Earth for five million years in the Cretaceous.



» 100 MYA

First bees

Once flowers had appeared so did flower-loving insects such as bees.



Dinosaurs and us

Dinosaurs existed for almost 170 million years, but this is just a moment in the 3.8 billion years of life on Earth. A huge range of animals and plants appeared before, alongside, and after them. Once dinosaurs had disappeared, other types of animal, like mammals, took over.

» 30 MYA

First cats

Early cats were meat-eaters, just like cats today.

